

Is transport 48% of Malta's effort-sharing emissions?

Testing a European Commission statement against EEA and Eurostat emissions data

THE CLAIM UNDER REVIEW

“Transport is the dominant source of Malta's effort sharing emissions. It has generated 48% of these emissions in 2024, up by 45% since 2005.”

European Commission, 2026 Country Report – Malta, SWD(2026) 218 final, 3 June 2026, p. 66.
The same figures appear on pp. 6 and 14. Footnote mark (141) omitted.

VERDICT: LARGELY SUPPORTED

Dominant and up 45%; the share is 53%, not 48%

Version 1.0 · 6 October 2026

Status: no right of reply needed

Prepared from public sources, EEA and Eurostat data.

Repository: github.com/leandergrech/Mizien

MIŻIEN · AN INDEPENDENT FACT-CHECKING PROJECT

Contest a verdict, with evidence: github.com/leandergrech/Mizien/issues

TL;DR

In its 2026 Country Report on Malta (3 June 2026), the European Commission wrote: **“Transport is the dominant source of Malta’s effort sharing emissions. It has generated 48% of these emissions in 2024, up by 45% since 2005.”** Effort-sharing emissions are those outside the EU’s emissions trading system that count towards Malta’s binding national target. We recomputed both numbers from the EEA and Eurostat data the report draws on.

- 1

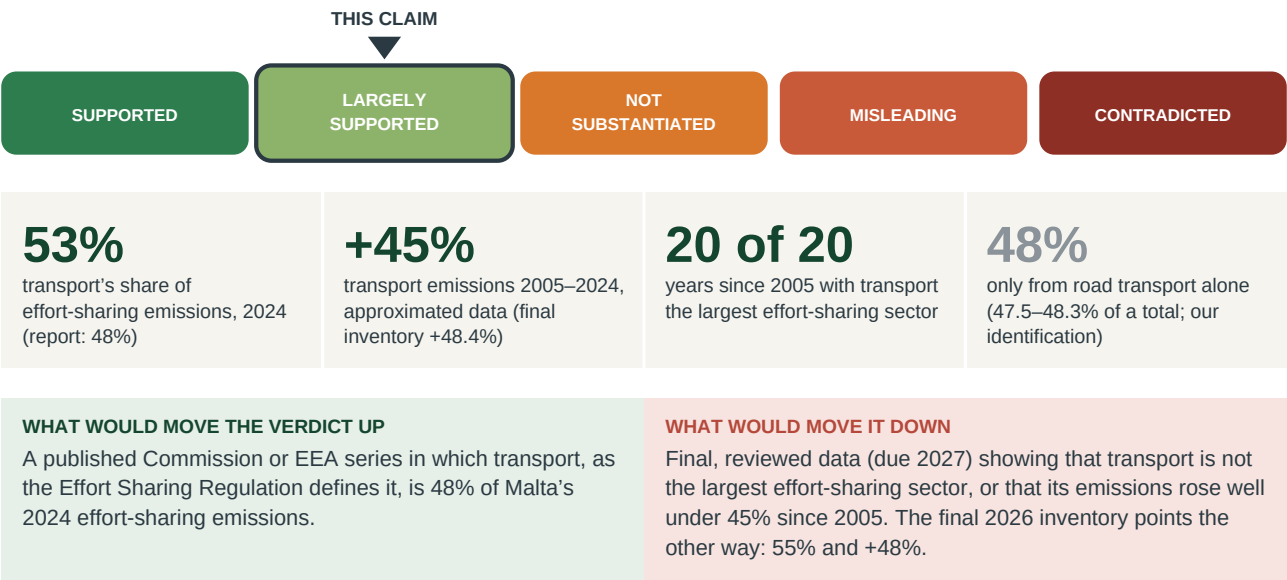
Transport is the dominant source. On the effort-sharing definition (all domestic transport, with aviation CO₂ excluded) transport was 53.3% of Malta’s effort-sharing emissions in 2024; the next sector, small industry, was 19%. Transport has been the largest sector in every year since 2005.
- 2

“Up by 45% since 2005” reproduces. Transport emissions rose from 0.528 Mt in 2005 to 0.766 Mt in 2024 on the approximated data the report uses: +45.0%, exactly its figure. That is the rise in emissions; the share barely moved (52.0% to 53.3%). The final 2026 inventory gives +48.4%.
- 3

The 48% does not reproduce; the share is 53%. The same definition gives 53.3% in the EEA’s approximated inventory and the report’s own Graph 3.1, and 53% in the Commission’s climate profile of Malta. Only road transport alone (47.5–48.3%) gives 48% (our identification; the report does not say). The 48% understates transport’s share.
- 4

The labels are narrower than the data. A footnote calls the sector “road transport” and the annex table labels its series “domestic road transport”, but the series includes domestic shipping (11.9% in 2024). 2024 figures are approximated; final data come in 2027.
- 5

Verdict: largely supported (high confidence). The substance holds, and on the report’s own definition transport’s share is larger than stated, not smaller.



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1

The claim and what we could verify

The claim is the Commission’s own text in a staff working document that accompanies its 2026 recommendation to the Council on Malta’s economic policies [1]. We read the Commission’s copy and the copy the Council registered as document 10135/26 ADD 1 in full on 6 October 2026; the wording is the same in both, only the page numbers differ (Commission copy pages are given here). The quoted sentence carries a footnote mark, (141), omitted on the cover; the footnote reads “See Table A8.1 at the end of this Annex.”

Where in the report [1]	What it says	Access
Annex 8, “Sustainable transport”, p. 66 (Council copy p. 72)	“Transport is the dominant source of Malta’s effort sharing emissions. It has generated 48% of these emissions in 2024 (141), up by 45% since 2005.”	Read in full; the claim
Chapter 3, p. 14 (Council p. 15)	“In terms of Malta’s effort sharing emissions, transport had a share of 48% in 2024, with emissions up by 45% since 2005 (see Graph 3.1 and Annex 8).”	Read in full
Summary, p. 6 (Council p. 6)	“The transport sector remains the biggest source of Effort Sharing Regulation emissions in 2024 (48%)”	Read in full
Graph 3.1, p. 14 (Council p. 16)	Effort-sharing emissions by sector, 2005, 2023 and 2024; “Domestic transport (excl. aviation)”; source: European Environment Agency.	Read; values taken from the PDF’s vector paths
Footnote (140) and Table A8.1, pp. 66 and 71 (Council pp. 72, 77)	Effort sharing covers “buildings (heating and cooling), road transport, agriculture, waste and small industry”; 2024 values “are based on approximated inventory data”. Table row “domestic road transport”: +45.0% in 2024. The table gives no share.	Read in full

FAIRNESS NOTE

An EU institution’s assessment of Malta is held to the same standard as a local statement. This check covers one sentence and its two figures. The 2030 projection in the same annex (+29.7% with additional measures, +42.1% with existing measures, against a –19% target; Table A8.1) is outside this check; Claim Checks 003 and 094 cover the Commission’s projections.

2

Method

Question. On the effort-sharing definition, was transport the largest source of Malta’s effort-sharing emissions in 2024, was it 48% of them, and had its emissions risen by 45% since 2005?

Evidence. The claim is statistical, so the evidence is the emissions data behind it: the EEA’s effort-sharing totals for 2005–2024 [4]; the EEA’s approximated (preliminary) inventory for 2024 [5], which the report uses for 2024; Malta’s final inventory for 2005–2024 as compiled by the EEA in April 2026 [7] and republished by Eurostat in June 2026 [6]; and the report’s own Graph 3.1, whose bar heights we read from the PDF’s drawing instructions [1]. We also read the Commission’s climate-progress profiles of Malta [8, 9], its 2025 Country Report [10] and the legal scope of effort sharing [2, 3]. Data were downloaded on 6 October 2026 (*tools/cc-109-report/fetch.py*, *read_graph.py*) and every figure is recomputed in *calc.py*, with results in *data/cc-109/checks.csv*. Eurostat sets no flags on the Malta rows used. A peer-reviewed study of Malta’s transport emissions [11] gives context.

Grades. Official statistics and legal texts are grade C under our scale. **Verdicts** follow the five-point scale in Appendix A.

3

What counts as transport, and which data

The legal definition. The Effort Sharing Regulation covers emissions from energy, industrial processes, agriculture and waste, minus the activities in the EU emissions trading system (ETS), except maritime transport, which stays in effort sharing [2, 3]. CO₂ from civil aviation (inventory category 1.A.3.a) is “treated as zero” [2]. So effort-sharing transport is all domestic transport (road, domestic shipping, rail and other) minus domestic-aviation CO₂. That is what Graph 3.1 calls “Domestic transport (excl. aviation)” and what the Commission’s climate profiles of Malta use [8, 9].

Inventory category	In effort sharing?	Malta 2005	Malta 2024	Change
1.A.3.b Road transport	Yes	0.495 Mt	0.690 Mt	+39.4%
1.A.3.d Domestic navigation	Yes (maritime stays in effort sharing)	0.033 Mt	0.093 Mt	+184%
1.A.3.c Rail, 1.A.3.e Other	Yes	not occurring	not occurring	–
1.A.3.a Domestic aviation, CO ₂	No (treated as zero)	0.002 Mt	0.004 Mt	–
Effort-sharing transport		0.528 Mt	0.784 Mt	+48.4%

Malta's final inventory, 2026 submission (Eurostat env_air_gge, updated 2 June 2026 [6]; identical to the EEA compilation of 15 March 2026 [7]). Greenhouse gases in CO₂ equivalent; rail and other transport carry the inventory notation “not occurring”.

Road transport is 88.1% of effort-sharing transport in 2024. A peer-reviewed study of Malta’s transport policy reports, from Malta’s Fourth Biennial Report, a similar split: road transport 87% of transport CO₂ [11 ♦]. The report’s footnote (140) shortens the sector to “road transport”, and Table A8.1 labels its series “domestic road transport”; section 4 shows that the series itself includes domestic shipping.

Approximated and final data. Member States report an approximated inventory for the previous year by 31 July; the EEA describes it as a preliminary indicator, with the full inventory a year later [5]. The report uses approximated data for 2024 (footnote 140) and says final effort-sharing figures will be set after a review in 2027 [1]. Malta’s final inventory for 2024 already exists: due by 15 March 2026 and compiled by the EEA in April [3, 7], it puts effort-sharing transport 2.3% above the approximated value [6, 7]. Approximations have moved further before: for 2023 the 2025 report gave transport +32.2% since 2005 [10], the 2026 report +44.8% [1].

4

What the data show

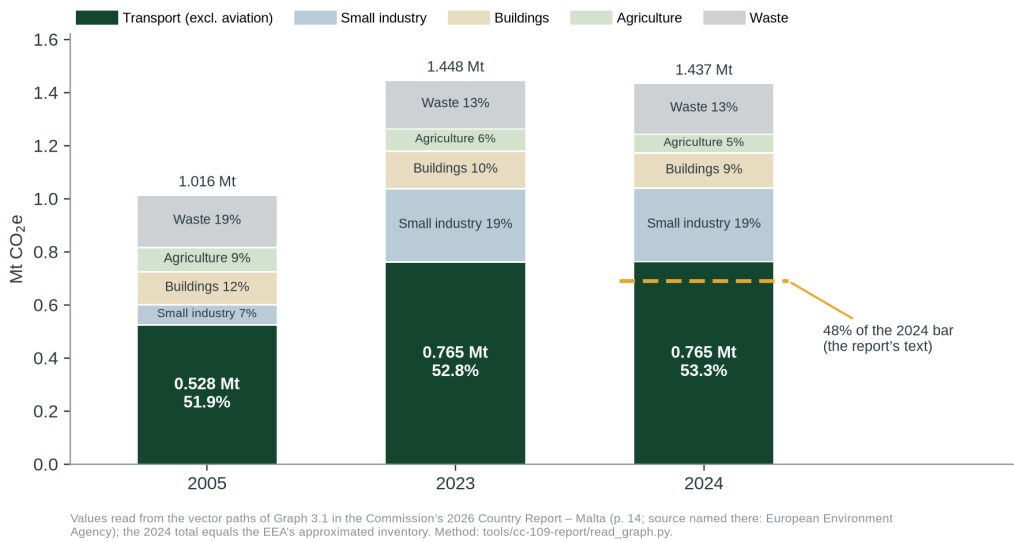


Figure 1. The report’s own Graph 3.1, redrawn from the values in the PDF’s drawing instructions [1]. Transport is the largest sector in all three years. In 2024 it is 0.765 of 1.437 Mt, or 53.3%; the amber line marks where 48% would fall. The 2024 bars equal the EEA’s approximated inventory [4, 5].

The share. The EEA's approximated inventory gives transport 0.766 Mt (all transport, 0.767 Mt, minus 0.9 kt of domestic-aviation CO₂) of an effort-sharing total of 1.437 Mt: 53.3% [5]. The EEA builds its total with the same aviation figure, so numerator and denominator match. The report's Graph 3.1, which the chapter-3 sentence cites, shows the same 53.3%, and the Commission's own climate-progress profile of Malta, published in January 2026, prints 53% for the same year and definition, against 39% for the EU-27 [8]. Its 2024 profile gave 52% for 2023 [9]. With the final 2026 inventory, and our estimate of the effort-sharing total, the share is 54.8% [6]. Small industry is second, at 19% (Figure 1).

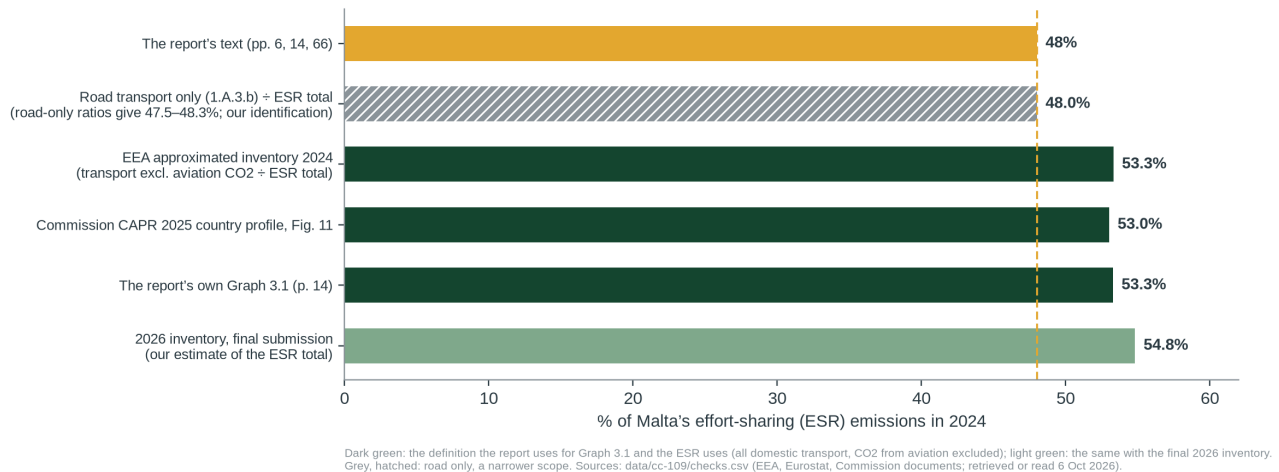


Figure 2. Transport's 2024 share of Malta's effort-sharing emissions by source and definition. Every source on the effort-sharing definition gives 53–55%. Only road transport alone, divided by an effort-sharing total, gives 48%.

Where could 48% come from? The report does not say. Footnote (141) points to Table A8.1, which gives no share. Of the combinations we tried, only ratios of road transport alone (47.5–48.3%) give 48%: road (1.A.3.b, 0.690 Mt) over the approximated effort-sharing total is 48.0%, road CO₂ alone 47.6%, road over our final-inventory total 48.3%, and road in 2023 47.5%. The 48.0% mixes a final-inventory numerator with an approximated denominator, because the approximated inventory has no road row. A road-only figure would fit footnote (140)'s wording ("road transport"), but this is our identification, not a stated method. If it is the source, the sentence mixes two scopes: road alone rose +39.4% since 2005, not 45%.



Greenhouse gases, CO₂ equivalent. Source: Eurostat env_air_gge (2026 inventory, updated 2 Jun 2026; no flags on these rows); Commission 2026 and 2025 Country Reports (Table A8.1). The 2024 Table A8.1 value rests on the approximated inventory (our recomputation from it: +45.0%). Retrieved or read 6 Oct 2026.

Figure 3. Change since 2005 in effort-sharing transport (green) and road transport alone (grey). Table A8.1's "domestic road transport" values (amber) sit on the green line for 2018–2023 (to the table's one-decimal precision) and up to 6.2 points off the road-only line; its 2024 value, +45.0%, equals our recomputation from the approximated inventory. The red marker is 2023 as approximated a year earlier.

The rise. Effort-sharing transport emitted 0.528 Mt in 2005. On the approximated 2024 data the report uses it was 0.766 Mt: +45.0% [1, 5], the same as Table A8.1 and Graph 3.1 (+45.0%). The report’s “45%” is that rise: the chapter-3 sentence says “with emissions up by 45%”, and transport’s share moved only from 52.0% to 53.3%. On the final 2026 inventory the rise is +48.4% [6], close to the +48.6% Claim Check 003 found for all domestic transport. Road transport rose +39.4% (cars +34%) and domestic navigation +184%: road gave 76% of the increase, shipping the rest, and shipping’s part of transport grew from 6.2% to 11.9%. Across the EU-27, effort-sharing transport fell 5.0% over the same years [6].

The 2005 baseline. The approximated 2024 total, 1.437 Mt, is 40.8% above Malta’s legal 2005 level of 1,020,601 t set in Commission Implementing Decision (EU) 2020/2126 [13]: the report’s “40.8% above 2005 levels” [1]. The EEA’s own 2005 estimate (1.007 Mt [4]) and Graph 3.1’s 2005 bar (1.016 Mt) differ slightly. The transport growth rate compares transport with itself, so it does not depend on which 2005 total is used.

Measure, Malta	Value	Source	Grade
Transport share of effort-sharing emissions, 2024: report's text	48%	[1] pp. 6, 14, 66	C
Same, approximated inventory / Graph 3.1 / climate profile	53.3% / 53.3% / 53%	[5] / [1] / [8]	C
Same, final 2026 inventory (our estimate of the total)	54.8%	[6, 5]	C
Road transport only ÷ an effort-sharing total, 2023–2024	47.5–48.3%	[4–6]	C
Transport emissions change 2005–2024: report's text	+45%	[1] pp. 14, 66	C
Same, approximated 2024 (= Graph 3.1, Table A8.1) / final inventory	+45.0% / +48.4%	[5, 6, 1] / [6]	C
Years 2005–2024 with transport the largest sector	20 of 20	[6]	C
EU-27: transport share 2024; transport change 2005–2024	39%; -5.0%	[8]; [6]	C

All values in data/cc-109/checks.csv. Effort-sharing transport = greenhouse gases from domestic transport minus aviation CO₂. The largest-sector count compares transport with buildings, agriculture, waste and industry plus F-gases in the inventory; Malta's ÉTS emissions are power generation plus 0.0003 Mt [5].

5

Where the evidence points different ways

Q1 Is transport 48% or 53% of Malta’s effort-sharing emissions?

53% ON THE REPORT'S DEFINITION

EVIDENCE FOR THE CLAIM'S IMPRESSION

Road transport alone is 47.5–48.3% of an effort-sharing total, and footnote (140) names the sector “road transport”. Read that way, the 48% is a correct number for a narrower category.

EVIDENCE AGAINST

The EEA’s approximated inventory and the report’s own Graph 3.1 (53.3%) and the Commission’s climate profile of Malta (53%) all use all domestic transport except aviation CO₂, the legal definition [2]. On that definition 48% is 5.3 points low.

WHY THEY DIFFER, AND WHAT IT MEANS HERE

For this claim: the sentence says “transport” and “these emissions”, and the report’s graph uses the wider definition, so 53% is the figure that matches the sentence. The 48% understates transport’s weight; it does not exaggerate it, and transport is the dominant source either way.

Q2 Does “up by 45% since 2005” hold, given that 2024 is approximated?

HOLDS; FINAL DATA GIVE
+48%

EVIDENCE FOR THE CLAIM'S IMPRESSION
On the approximated 2024 data the report uses, the rise is +45.0%, and the report's Table A8.1 reproduces exactly from the inventory for 2018–2023 and from the approximated inventory for 2024.

EVIDENCE AGAINST
Approximations can be revised a long way: the 2025 report put 2023 at +32.2%, the final inventory at +44.8%. The final effort-sharing figures for 2024 will only be set after the 2027 review.

WHY THEY DIFFER, AND WHAT IT MEANS HERE
For this claim: the final 2026 inventory already gives +48.4%, so the revision so far has raised the figure. “Up by 45%” is accurate on the data the report used and conservative on the newer data.

6

Testing the claim

Sub-claim	Said by	What the evidence shows	Rating
A. Transport is the dominant source of Malta's effort sharing emissions	Commission [1]	53.3% in 2024 on the approximated data; the next sector, small industry, 19%. The largest sector in every year 2005–2024 [5, 6].	ACCURATE
B. It has generated 48% of these emissions in 2024	Commission [1]	53% on the report's own definition: EEA approximated inventory and Graph 3.1 53.3%, Commission climate profile 53% [1, 5, 8]. Only road-transport-only ratios (47.5–48.3%) give 48% (our identification).	UNDERSTATED
C. ... up by 45% since 2005	Commission [1]	The rise in emissions, not in the share: +45.0% on approximated 2024 data (0.528 to 0.766 Mt); +48.4% on the final 2026 inventory [1, 5, 6]. The share moved from 52.0% to 53.3%.	ACCURATE
D. Effort sharing covers “road transport”; Table A8.1 row “domestic road transport”	Commission [1], footnote (140), Table A8.1	Effort sharing covers all domestic transport except aviation CO ₂ [2, 3]. The table row matches that wider series to 0.1 points in 2018–2023 and exactly in 2024 (45.0%); road alone is up to 6.2 points off (2024: +39.4%). Shipping is 11.9% of it [6].	LOOSELY WORDED

Reading the sentence. “Up by 45% since 2005” could in principle mean that transport’s share rose by 45%. The chapter-3 version of the same sentence says “with emissions up by 45%”, and the share moved only from 52.0% to 53.3%, so we rate the reading the report itself gives.

7 Verdict and requests for evidence

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

Transport is the dominant source and its emissions rose about 45% since 2005. On the report's own definition its share is 53%, not 48%. Confidence: high.

Why. (1) Transport is the largest effort-sharing sector by a wide margin, in 2024 and in every year since 2005. (2) The 45% rise reproduces from the approximated data the report uses, and the final inventory gives more (+48.4%). (3) The 48% does not reproduce on the definition the report uses in its own graph; that definition gives 53%, as does the Commission's climate profile of Malta. Because 48% understates transport's share, and the sentence's message (transport dominates and is growing) holds more strongly on the correct figure, this is a minor caveat, not a change of substance. (4) Confidence is high because the EEA's datasets, Malta's inventory and two Commission documents agree. No right of reply is needed for this verdict.

What this verdict does not say. It does not assess the Commission's 2030 projection, its policy recommendations or the causes of the rise in transport emissions.

Evidence we are asking for

- ☐ From the Commission: the series and calculation behind the 48% (Table A8.1, which footnote (141) cites, gives no share), and whether it is road transport alone.
- ☐ From the Commission: confirmation that Table A8.1's "domestic road transport" row includes domestic navigation, as its values imply.
- ☐ From the EEA or the Commission: final effort-sharing figures for 2024 by sector after the 2027 review.

8 Limitations

- The 2024 effort-sharing total is approximated; the final, reviewed figure will be set in 2027.
- Graph 3.1 was read from the PDF's drawing instructions, not from a data table; the 2024 total read this way (1.437 Mt) matches the EEA's figure to 0.001 Mt.
- Our effort-sharing total on the final 2026 inventory is an estimate (total excluding land use, minus ETS emissions from the approximated inventory, minus aviation CO₂).
- We could not see how the Commission computed 48%; the road-only route is our identification only.
- The EEA greenhouse gas data viewer named in Table A8.1 draws its charts in JavaScript; we used the EEA datasets behind it. Malta's UNFCCC reporting tables were not opened; the EEA's compilation of the same submission was used.
- The study cited for road's share of transport CO₂ [11] takes it from Malta's Fourth Biennial Report, which we did not read (marked ♦).

References

- [1] European Commission (3 Jun 2026). 2026 Country Report – Malta. SWD(2026) 218 final; Council document 10135/26 ADD 1 (8 Jun 2026). Read in full 6 Oct 2026; Commission-copy pages 6, 14, 66, 71 (Council copy 6, 15–16, 72, 77). https://economy-finance.ec.europa.eu/document/download/b0bb0c3b-1b52-4ac5-8090-ee21edf1e039_en?filename=MT_SWD_2026_218_1_EN_autre_document_travail_service_part1_v1.pdf

- [2] Regulation (EU) 2018/842 (Effort Sharing Regulation), Article 2. OJ L 156, 19.6.2018, p. 26. Read via the EU Publications Office, 6 Oct 2026. <http://data.europa.eu/eli/reg/2018/842/oj>
- [3] Regulation (EU) 2023/857 amending Regulation (EU) 2018/842, Article 1(2) (scope) and Article 2(1) (final inventories by 15 March). OJ L 111, 26.4.2023, p. 1. Read via the EU Publications Office, 6 Oct 2026. <http://data.europa.eu/eli/reg/2023/857/oj>
- [4] European Environment Agency (6 Nov 2025). Greenhouse gas emissions under the Effort Sharing Legislation, 2005–2024. Dataset, doi:10.2909/f80bebef-447e-4882-b3e9-c4a91cbae4f5. Retrieved 6 Oct 2026. <https://doi.org/10.2909/f80bebef-447e-4882-b3e9-c4a91cbae4f5>
- [5] European Environment Agency (5 Nov 2025). GovReg: Approximated estimates for greenhouse gas emissions, 2024 (with statistical metadata). Dataset, doi:10.2909/cd572015-4d0d-408a-abf8-290ed2057bf7. Retrieved 6 Oct 2026. <https://doi.org/10.2909/cd572015-4d0d-408a-abf8-290ed2057bf7>
- [6] Eurostat. Greenhouse gas emissions by source sector (env_air_gge), updated 2 Jun 2026, doi:10.2908/ENV_AIR_GGE. Retrieved 6 Oct 2026; no flags on the Malta rows used. https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/databrowser/view/env_air_gge/default/table
- [7] European Environment Agency (17 Apr 2026). GovReg: National emissions reported to the UNFCCC and to the EU under the Governance Regulation, 2026 ver. 1.0 (data of 15 Mar 2026). Dataset, doi:10.2909/83ee8f8c-1422-4e3f-af63-ba88146811e5. Retrieved 6 Oct 2026. <https://doi.org/10.2909/83ee8f8c-1422-4e3f-af63-ba88146811e5>
- [8] European Commission, DG Climate Action (Jan 2026). Climate Action Progress Report 2025: country profile Malta, pp. 9–10 (Figure 11). Read in full 6 Oct 2026. https://climate.ec.europa.eu/document/download/acb92e05-4220-44c3-9483-b3524c326f59_en?filename=mt_2025_factsheet_en.pdf
- [9] European Commission, DG Climate Action. Climate Action Progress Report 2024: country profile Malta (2023 data), pp. 5–6. Read 6 Oct 2026. https://climate.ec.europa.eu/document/download/4c335e40-6961-4473-9cc0-5b6367f75a6e_en?filename=mt_2024_factsheet_en.pdf
- [10] European Commission (4 Jun 2025). 2025 Country Report – Malta. SWD(2025) 218 final, pp. 67, 69. Read 6 Oct 2026. https://economy-finance.ec.europa.eu/document/download/be493fbf-cb70-432c-a68a-13067176ff38_en?filename=MT_CR_SWD_2025_218_1_EN_autre_document_travail_service_part1_v5.pdf
- [11] Camilleri R., Attard M., Hickman R. (2024). Participatory policy packaging for transport backcasting: a pathway for reducing CO₂ emissions from transport in Malta. *Sustainability* 16(1):430. doi:10.3390/su16010430. Full text read (CC BY 4.0); its road share comes from Malta's Fourth Biennial Report ♦. <https://doi.org/10.3390/su16010430>
- [12] Mizien. Data and calculations: data/cc-109/; tools/cc-109-report/ (fetch.py, read_graph.py, calc.py). Claim Check 003 for the earlier figures (data/cc-003/).
- [13] Commission Implementing Decision (EU) 2020/2126 of 16 December 2020 setting out the annual emission allocations of the Member States for 2021–2030, Annex I (Malta, 2005: 1 020 601 t CO₂e). OJ L 426, 17.12.2020, p. 58. Read via the EU Publications Office, 6 Oct 2026. https://data.europa.eu/eli/dec_impl/2020/2126/oj

Appendix A: series standards and verdict scale

Every investigation in this series follows the same rules so that verdicts are comparable and challengeable.

Verdict	Meaning
SUPPORTED	Evidence consistently backs the claim as stated.
LARGELY SUPPORTED	Backed by the evidence, with minor caveats that do not change the substance.
NOT SUBSTANTIATED	Stated more strongly than the evidence offered or available allows. May be true in some conditions but has not been shown.
MISLEADING	Omits material facts so that the overall impression is inaccurate, even if individual statements are defensible.
CONTRADICTED	The available evidence points against the claim.

Confidence

High: multiple independent lines of evidence agree. **Moderate:** evidence is relevant but incomplete or indirect. **Low:** evidence is thin, second-hand or conflicting.

Evidence grades

A experiment · B observational study with a control or gradient · C review, guidance or official statistics · D assertion or anecdote. ♦ marks a source known only second-hand.

Standards

- **Quote the speaker, not the headline**, with outlet and date, and link the original where possible.
- **Separate the claim from the evidence offered for it**, and say who made which statement.
- **Grade the evidence** and show differing views side by side where the evidence is unsettled.
- **State what we could not access or verify**, and what would change the verdict either way.
- **Ask for the missing evidence** in specific, answerable requests.
- **Offer a right of reply** where a check finds a claim Not substantiated, Misleading or Contradicted (or a pledge Not measurable, Off track or Missed), before wider circulation, and append responses.
- **Correct errors openly** with a version number and change log.
- **Whistle-blow only on evidence:** a verdict of *Misleading* or *Contradicted* requires documents or data that can be shown, not inference.
- **Check every side.** Government, opposition, NGOs and developers are held to the same standard.

Appendix B: revision log

Version	Date	Change
1.0	6 Oct 2026	First issue. Largely supported (high confidence); no right of reply needed.